
HS 555: Infrastructural Development in Highland South Asia

Course Code : HS 555

Course Name : Infrastructural Development in Highland South Asia

L-T-P-C : 3-0-0-3

Intended for : M.A. (Development Studies) (Discipline Elective) and B.Tech. 3rd and 4th year

Prerequisite :

Mutual Exclusion:

Approval: 54th BoA

Course Contents

- Introduction to Anthropology of infrastructure (6 Hours)
 - The infrastructural turn
 - The mobility paradigm in anthropology
 - Promises and perils of infrastructural creation in highland South Asia
 - Road Ethnographies
- Connecting the remote: The poetics and politics (8 Hours)
 - From mule tracks to imperial highways
 - Remoteness and connectivity channels
 - Roads as the harbinger of progress, development and connectivity
 - Roads as state conceived spaces
 - Land acquisition and other issues.
- The Dromocratic revolution (6 Hours)
 - Speed and flows
 - Connection and communication channels
 - Corporeal and kinetic connection
- Mobility and Mobile connections (8 Hours)
 - Embodied travel experiences
 - Temporal and material conditions of infrastructure
 - Roadside contacts: stationary and the non-stationary
 - People as infrastructures: Gender experiences of mobility
- Tunneling and damming the hills (8 Hours)
 - The destructive production of infrastructure: railway tunnels and aerial connection
 - Dams and the moral ecology of infrastructure
 - Debris and debacle along infrastructure channels
 - Extraction of Raw-materials

- Infrastructure and Sustainability (6 Hours)
 - Issues of sustainability in infrastructure development
 - Loss of forested lands, natural habitats and other environmental concerns
 - Environmental Impact Assessment and other issues
 - Negotiating the loss.

Laboratory/practical/tutorial Modules:

Field visits, invited lectures, film screening and other activities including evaluation of the Environmental and Social Impact assessment reports submitted before the commencement of the project.

Textbooks:

1. Anand, Nikhil, Akhil Gupta, and Hannah Appel, **The Promise of Infrastructure**, Duke University Press 2018.
2. Harvey, Penny, Casper Bruun Jensen, and Atsuro Morita, **Infrastructures and Social Complexity: A Companion**, Taylor & Francis, 2016.
3. Dalakoglou, D., Harvey, P. (Eds.), **Roads and Anthropology: Ethnography, Infrastructures, (Im)mobility**, Routledge, 2014.

References:

1. Appel, Hannah, Anand, Nikhil and Gupta, Akhil Introduction: The Infrastructure Toolbox | Society for Cultural Anthropology (culanth.org), 2015.
2. Adey, P., Bissell, D., Hannam, K., Merriman, P., & Sheller, M. (Eds.), *The Routledge Handbook of Mobilities*, Routledge, 2013.
3. Bhatt, Jay P, Sudha Tiwari & Maharaj K. Pandit, Environmental impact assessment of river valley projects in upper Teesta basin of Eastern Himalaya with special reference to fish conservation: a review. *Impact Assessment and Project Appraisal*, 35:4, 340-350, DOI: [10.1080/14615517.2017.1354642](https://doi.org/10.1080/14615517.2017.1354642), 2017.
4. Cresswell, Tim and Peter Merriman., *Geographies of Mobilities: Practices, Spaces, Subjects*, Taylor & Francis, 2016.
5. Dalakoglou, D., *The road: An ethnography of the Albanian-Greek cross-border motorway*, *American Ethnologist*, no. 37 (1):132-149, 2010.
6. Delmon, Jeffrey, *Public Private Partnership projects in Infrastructure: An essential guide for policy makers*, Cambridge University Press, 2011.
7. Demenge, Jonathan P., *The Road to Lingshed: Manufactured Isolation and Experienced Mobility in Ladakh*. *Himalaya, the Journal of the Association for Nepal and Himalayan Studies*, 32 (1): 51–60, 2013.
8. Ferguson, J., *The Anti-Politics Machine: 'Development,' Depoliticization, and Bureaucratic Power in Lesotho*. 2003 ed. Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press, 1994.

9. Gohain, Swargajyoti, *Imagined Geographies in the Indo-Tibetan Borderlands: Culture, Politics, Place*. Netherlands: Amsterdam University Press, 2020.
10. Gordillo, Gaston, *Rubble: The afterlife of destruction*. Durham: Duke University Press, 2014.
11. Gupta, Akhil, *The future in ruins: Thoughts on the temporality of infrastructure*. In N. Anand et al (eds.), *The Promise of Infrastructure*, Duke University Press, 2018.
12. Harvey, Penny., Knox, Hannah, *The Enchantments of Infrastructure*. *Mobilities*, 7:4, 521-536, DOI: [10.1080/17450101.2012.718935](https://doi.org/10.1080/17450101.2012.718935), 2012.
13. Harvey, Penny., Knox, Hannah, *Roads: An Anthropology of Infrastructure and Expertise*, Cornell University Press, 2015.
14. Masquelier, A., *Road Mythographies: Space, Mobility, and the Historical Imagination in Postcolonial Niger*, *American Ethnologist*, 29 (4):829-856, 2002.
15. Murton, Galen and Luke Heslop, *Highways and Hierarchies: Ethnographies of Mobility from the Himalaya to the Indian Ocean*, Amsterdam University Press, 2021.
16. Murton, Galen and Austin Lord, *Trans-Himalayan power corridors: Infrastructural politics and China's Belt and Road Initiative in Nepal*, *Political Geography*, 77 (102100): 1- 13, 2020.
17. Negi, D. P., & Abdul Azeez EP., 'No Means No': People's Protest Against Hydroelectric Development in Kinnaur, Himachal Pradesh, India, *Contemporary Voice of Dalit*, <https://doi.org/10.1177/2455328X2110694>, 2022.
18. Rest, Matthaus and Alessandro, Rippa, *Road animism*. *HAU: Journal of Ethnographic Theory*, 9: 373 - 389, 2019.
19. Saxer, Martin, *Places in Knots: Remoteness and Connectivity in the Himalayas and Beyond*, Cornell University Press, 2022.
20. Simpson, Edward, *Highways to the End of the World: Roads, Roadmen and Power in South Asia*, Hurst Publishers, 2022.
21. Simone, Abdou, Maliq, *People as Infrastructure: Intersecting Fragments in Johannesburg*, *Public Culture*, 16 (3): 407-429, 2004.
22. Star, Susan. Leigh, *The Ethnography of Infrastructure*. *American Behavioral Scientists*, 43 (3): 377-391, 1999.
23. Wiejaczka, Łukasz; Danuta Pirog; Lakpa Tamang; and Paweł Prokop, *Local Residents' Perceptions of a Dam and Reservoir Project in the Teesta Basin, Darjeeling Himalayas, India*. *Mountain Research and Development*, 38 (3): 203-210 <http://dx.doi.org/10.1659/MRD-JOURNAL-D-16-00124.1>, 2018
24. Ziipao, R. Raile, *Infrastructure of Injustice: State and Politics in Manipur and Northeast India*, Routledge, 2020.